Aiswarya Senthil

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Education

Cornell University, College of Arts & Sciences *Ithaca, NY*
Bachelor of Arts in Cognitive Science, Minor in Information Science, GPA: 3.9/4.0 *Expected May 2028*
Relevant Coursework: Statistics & Research Design, Human-AI Interaction Design Research, Undergraduate Research in Cognitive Science, Object-Oriented Programming & Data Structures, Understanding Artificial Intelligence, Intro Design & Programming for the Web, Game Theory, Intro to Cognitive Science, Cognitive Development

Wellesley College *Wellesley, MA*
Field of Study: Cognitive Science, Concentration in Computer Science, GPA: 3.5/4.0 *Aug 2024 - May 2025*
Relevant Coursework: Computer Programming & Problem-Solving; Intro to Linguistics; Intro to Microeconomics; Brain, Behavior, and Cognition: Intro to Neuroscience; Intro to Psychology; Calculus I

Academic Research

Virtual Embodiment Lab at Cornell University *Ithaca, NY*
Undergraduate Research Assistant *Jan 2026 - Present*

- Leading Guided Immersion, a cross-institutional study (continued from UMN NSF REU) on how a guided preamble affects stress recovery in VR nature environments; wrote the IRB protocol and obtained approval, recruited a collaborator, and prepared for participant data collection in fall 2026
- Collected data for a graduate researcher's psychophysical study on VR embodiment for pain modulation (Medoc Q-Sense thermal device)
- Facilitated live multi-user VR sessions studying how shared virtual environments influence participants' behavior in sync with one another

Design + Augmented Intelligence Lab at Cornell University *Ithaca, NY*
Undergraduate Research Assistant *Sep 2025 - Present*

- Recruiting and screening participants for SERVE (Social Engaging Restorative Virtual Environment), an NIH/NIA-funded intervention with Weill Cornell Medicine that improves accessibility for older adults with mild cognitive impairment
- Assisting the research team on home visits for Phase 2B data collection with older adults
- Conducting a heuristic evaluation of SERVE's VR interventions and training modules
- Designed UX visualizations for a Unity-based VR tutorial within SERVE
- Wrote the script for and directed an onboarding film teaching older adults to use VR hardware

National Science Foundation Human-Computer Interaction REU *Pittsburgh, PA*
Undergraduate Researcher (Carnegie Mellon Human-Computer Interaction Institute) *May 2026 - Aug 2026*

- Co-designed and iteratively tested SCAMP, a tool that coaches human red-teamers across multi-turn chatbot attacks while supporting their well-being; tested whether a model could recognize attack techniques (e.g., goal reframing, role-play) from user prompts
- Planned and ran multiple feedback sessions with peer researchers, several independently, to test the prototype and guide its redesign, informed by 15+ papers and reports on AI safety testing; continuing analysis and writing toward a November 2026 FAccT submission

National Science Foundation Human-Centered Computing for Social Good REU *Minneapolis, MN*
Undergraduate Researcher (University of Minnesota Twin Cities - Virtual Reality Lab) *Jun 2025 - Aug 2025*

- Engineered a custom visual programming pipeline from scratch within Unreal Engine 5 to investigate the impact of narrative preambles on stress recovery
- Programmed a timer-based loop to record precise behavioral data at 10 Hz, extracting 6 degrees of freedom (6-DOF) spatial coordinates and head rotation kinematics
- Designed the full study protocol, including heart rate and skin conductance measures and standardized surveys on mood, sense of recovery, and mental workload

Other Experience

Collaboration with Táhila Moss (Indigenous Artist and National Geographic Explorer) *Ithaca, NY*
Volunteer Technical Lead *Feb 2026 - Present*

- Designed an accessible Meta Quest VR app bringing 360-degree nature films to older adults and Indigenous communities in the Finger Lakes; currently building the app
- Transcribed and organized handwritten surveys from senior living residents aged 66 to 95, surfacing headset discomfort and motion sickness that shaped the accessible app design

Cornell Undergraduate Research Board (CURB) *Ithaca, NY*
Peer Mentor *Feb 2026 - Present*

- Mentoring 10 aspiring undergraduate researchers (eight during Fall 2026, two during Spring 2026), mostly students of color seeking positions in engineering and computing labs, on lab placements, NSF REU applications, personal statements, and cold outreach

Center for Teaching Innovation – Creative Technology Lab *Ithaca, NY*
Project Manager & Creative Technologist *Sep 2025 - Present*

- Serving as Project Manager for the XR Anatomy for Cornell Veterinary Medicine Project, directing a cross-functional team to bring uncompressed 3D photogrammetry models of biological specimens into VR headsets; working toward open-access delivery on desktops and headsets for rural schools
- Deploying course-specific VR/AR tools in Anatomy & Physiology, Cell Biology, and Mechanical Engineering courses, working with instructors and students in in-person class settings to test and refine learning modules

LPGA*USGA Girls Golf *Kenilworth, NJ*
Coach & Site Advisor, Head eLeader (Greater Union site), **National eLeader Director** *Mar 2022 - Present*

- **Coach & Site Advisor** (Jul 2024 – Present):
  - Collaborating with site leadership to conduct post-season reviews using the POW evaluation method, implementing specific operational improvements for the curriculum
  - Leveraging over 15 years of golf experience and prior Head eLeader background to advise the current team and coach students during clinics
- **Head eLeader** (Mar 2022 – Jul 2024) **& National eLeader Director** (Feb 2023 – Dec 2023)
  - Selected as 1 of 13 National Board members (out of 400+ eLeaders), collaborated with headquarters to plan and execute policy, diversity, and inclusion strategy, impacting 90,000+ members across 500+ sites nationwide
  - Managed a team of 10 eLeaders and mentored 60+ girls (ages 6 – 17, primarily Black and brown girls), translating insights about their needs into educational scaffolds and improved lesson plans that built resilience, teamwork, and optimism through golf
  - Organized a local recruitment event where 40% of ~70 attendees were new to golf, expanding program reach, generating a waitlist for the next season, and driving national membership growth

Awards, Honors, & Certifications

- **NSF Research Experience for Undergraduates Fellow (2x) -** University of Minnesota, 2025; Carnegie Mellon University, 2026
- CITI Human Subjects Research (IRB) Training, 2025
- CITI GCP — Social and Behavioral Research Best Practices for Clinical Research, 2025
- CITI Training on Financial Conflicts of Interest Related to Research (COI), 2026
- **New Jersey State Seal of Biliteracy** (Spanish)

Presentations

- Senthil, A. (2025, August). *Guided Immersion: The Impact of a Preamble in Virtual Nature Experiences for Stress & Attentional Fatigue.* Poster presentation. Summer Undergraduate Research Expo, University of Minnesota Twin Cities.
- Senthil, A. (2026, May). *Guided Immersion: The Impact of a Preamble in Virtual Nature Experiences for Stress & Attentional Fatigue.* Poster and oral presentation. Cornell Undergraduate Research Board Spring Symposium, Cornell University.
- Senthil, A. (2026, July). *SCAMP: Scaffolding Creative Adversarial Multi-turn Prompting for Red-Teaming Generative AI.* Poster presentation. Human-Computer Interaction Institute Research Experience for Undergraduates Poster Session, Carnegie Mellon University.

Technical Skills & Tools

- **Collaboration & Design:** UI/UX Design, Figma, Git, VS Code, Canva, Adobe Creative Suite, Atlassian Jira
- **Programming:** Python, Java, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Blueprint Visual Scripting (self-taught)
- **Data Analysis & Research:** Experimental Design, Qualitative Analysis, Survey Design, Microsoft Office Suite, Wireframing, Prototyping, Mixed Methods Research, User Research, Biometric Sensor Integration
- **Mixed Reality & Game Development:** Unity, Unreal Engine, Meta Quest, Snap Spectacles, Samsung XR, Apple Vision Pro, Meta Ray-Bans, Blender
- **Languages:** Spanish (bilingual, NJ State Seal of Biliteracy), Tamil (native)